WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL

Defect Standard: Drainage

Document Standard 03 | Issue 4 | Owner: Highways Asset Management | Review cycle: every twelve months

1. Purpose and scope

This standard sets out what a report of its defect type must show before a Highways Inspector may order a repair straight from the report, and what follows the decision.

It is used by the Street Care Coordinator or Highways Inspector who opens a review, by the Highways Inspector who decides it, and by the residents, businesses, councillors, bus operators and schools who report defects, as the Highways Policy describes.

Each defect type has its own defect standard. The five defect standards share one layout and many of the same sentences; they differ in what the defect type covers, in the requirements of section 4 and how section 5 reads them, and in what an inspection records, the writing that follows a decision and the reasons that sections 6 to 9 give. A report is always reviewed under the standard of its own defect type, and under the standard of its linked defect type where it has one; a requirement in one standard never applies to a report of another defect type unless the report is linked to it.

The standard applies to every report of its defect type, whichever channel it comes through.

2. What this standard covers

This standard covers standing water and blocked drainage on any street the council maintains: gullies and gratings that do not take the water away, and water that stands on the carriageway or the footway after rain.

Water standing in a pothole may be reported as a drainage defect with carriageway as its linked defect type, and water standing on a broken footway as one with footway, or either the other way round; either way the report must meet both standards.

The defect type is Drainage.

3. Who reports

A report is made by whoever sees the defect - a resident, a business, a councillor, a bus operator or a school - through one of three channels: the council website's report form, the StreetCare app on a phone, or a telephone call that the contact centre types up.

The report gives the street, its district and its street category, where on the street the defect is and whether that location is fixed, the defect type and any linked defect type, and the answers its requirements read. The council adds how many reports the same location has had before and the planned crew hours from its own standard times. The documents attached to a report - a resident description, a call note, a photo note or an inspection note from an earlier visit - describe the defect.

A drainage report gives how deep the water stands, whether it stands on the carriageway or the footway and, on the carriageway, how far it reaches from the kerb, and whether a photograph is attached.

4. Requirements

Every requirement below must be Met for a Highways Inspector to order a repair straight from the report. Each requirement is stated once, in one sentence, and a report is screened against all of them, in this order:

1 **Location fixed.** The location of the defect is fixed to a house number, a lamp column number or a road junction.

2 **Photograph.** A photograph of the defect is attached to the report.

3 **Water depth.** The standing water is at least 50 millimetres deep.

4 **Water reach.** Where the water stands on the carriageway, it reaches at least 1.0 metres out from the kerb.

A requirement is never met by a sentence in a statement, and is never waived.

5. Reading the requirements

Each requirement is Met, Not met or Not documented on the report as the Report Rules read it. The latest revision of a report is the report; an earlier revision is never screened.

- A location is fixed when the report ties the defect to a house number, a lamp column number or a road junction, so that a crew can find it without a search. The requirement is met when the report records the location fixed, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- A photograph attached to the report shows the defect as the reporter saw it. The requirement is met when the report records a photograph attached, not met when it records that it is not, and not documented when the answer is blank.
- The water depth is the deepest standing water at the defect, in whole millimetres as the Report Rules read it. A depth of exactly the figure meets the requirement, a shallower one fails it, and a blank depth is not documented.
- The water reach is a follow-on question, decided by where the water stands. On the footway it is met whatever else the report says. On the carriageway it is met when the water reaches at least the figure out from the kerb, in metres to one decimal as the Report Rules convert it from feet, not met when it reaches less, and not documented when the reach is blank. A blank water location is not documented and asks for the water location alone.

A requirement that is not documented names the answers it needs, so that the inspection can find them.

A report with a linked defect type is screened under this standard and under the linked type's, and must meet both. The documents never decide a requirement. A measurement sentence whose figure differs from the report's own, or gives a figure the report left blank, is flagged for the Highways Inspector, and the report's answer still decides.

6. What an inspection records

When a report is sent for inspection on site, the inspector who visits records what this standard needs to decide the repair: how deep the water stands and where, how far it reaches from the kerb on the carriageway, the state of the gully grating, a photograph and the location fixed to a house number, a lamp column or a junction.

7. The works order

The works order goes to the council's repair contractor when a Highways Inspector orders a repair under this standard. It names the report by its report reference and defect type, says the repair is ordered, and gives the street, the location, the defect's own measurements and the repair this section names: a gully cleanse, or a drain repair where the water stood 150 millimetres deep or more or the location has been reported twice or more before. A linked defect type is named with its own repair. It asks the contractor to clear the gully and its connection, and to leave the grating seated. The works order carries no figure from a model.

8. The resident update

The resident update is written after the works order, for the person who reported the defect. It tells them in plain words that a repair has been ordered, what will be done and where. For drainage it says that the gully will be cleared so that the water can drain away. Where the repair depends on a linked defect, the update says so. The update never gives the repeat likelihood, the expected crew hours or any other figure from a model, never promises when the work will be done, and never names any member of the council's staff.

9. Why these requirements

Standing water hides the surface under it, sprays people walking past and, in cold weather, freezes. A drainage repair is ordered straight from a report when the water stands at least as deep as section 4 gives and, on the carriageway, reaches far enough from the kerb to push traffic out of its lane.

On the footway, standing water at that depth blocks the path wherever it reaches, so how far it reaches is not asked.

Highways Asset Management owns this standard, reviews it every twelve months and issues any amendment as a new issue of this document, replacing every earlier issue.